

who agree in supposing it to refer to the conquest of Babylon by Cyrus, and ascribe it accordingly to a prophet living towards the close of the exile.

21, 11-12. On Dumah (*i.e.* Edom). A call of inquiry reaches the prophet from Seir (Gen. 36, 8 f.): he replies, in dark and enigmatic terms, that though the "morning" (*i.e.* brighter days) may dawn for Edom, it will quickly be followed by a "night" of trouble; for the present no more favourable answer can be given.

21, 13-17. On 'Arāb. A tide of invasion is about to overflow the region inhabited by 'Arāb and Kedar (*v.* 17); the Dedanite caravans passing through it have to seek refuge in the woods: the people of Têma bring supplies to the fugitive traders. Within a year Kedar will be so reduced in numbers, that only an insignificant remnant will survive.

'Arāb denotes not Arabia (in our sense of the word), but a particular nomad tribe inhabiting the N. of the Peninsula, and mentioned Ez. 27, 20 f., with Dedan and Kedar, as engaged in commerce with Tyre. Kedar was a wealthy pastoral tribe, 60, 7. Jer. 49, 29. Têma lay some 250 miles S.-E. of Edom. Sargon's troops were engaged in war with the Philistines in both 720 and 711: and it may be conjectured that these two prophecies were delivered in view of an expected campaign of the Assyrians in the neighbouring regions in one of these years.

22, 1-14. A rebuke, addressed by Isaiah to the inhabitants of the capital, on account of the undignified temper displayed by them when their city was threatened with an assault by the foe. *V.* 1 describes the demeanour of the people; *vv.* 2-3 the events which had preceded; *vv.* 4-5 the grief and shame overwhelming the prophet in consequence; *vv.* 6-12 the hasty measures of defence which had been taken by the people, and the inappropriate temper manifested by them at the time and subsequently: *v.* 13 is the prophet's rebuke.

The prophecy belongs probably to either 711 or 701 B.C. In 711 B.C. Sargon's troops were in the neighbourhood of Judah (engaged upon the siege of Ashdod); and as Judah is mentioned at the same time as "speaking treason" against him, it is possible that some collision may have taken place with Sargon's soldiers, resulting in a panic and defeat, such as Isaiah describes.¹ The objection to referring it to 701, the year of Sennacherib's invasion, is its minatory tone; for in the other prophecies belonging undoubtedly to this period, Isaiah makes it his aim to encourage and sustain

¹ But the hypothesis that Sargon gained a series of successes, and even ended by capturing Jerusalem, lacks adequate historical foundation, and must be rejected (see W. R. Smith, *Proph.* p. 295 ff.; *Isaiah*, p. 101 f.; Schrader, *KAT.* p. 407 f.; Kuen. § 41. 4c; Dillm. pp. 3, 103, 197).